



CRAB-LIKE SPINY
ORB-WEAVER



ORANGE
BABOON
TARANTULA



MEXICAN RED-KNEED
TARANTULA



RAFT
SPIDER



WHIP
SPIDER



COMMON
HARVESTMAN



BROAD-HEADED
PSEUDOSCORPION

OTHER ARACHNIDS

The arachnid family includes other animals such as mites, ticks, and harvestmen. They are often mistaken for insects, but they are not, mainly because they all have eight legs, not six, and two body segments, instead of three.

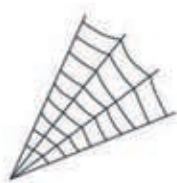
WEB TYPES

Different species of spider produce different types of webs. Orb spiders produce the most widely recognized web.



ORB WEB

Spun by orb web spiders, this type of web needs repairing every day.



TRIANGULAR WEB

This type is spun by non-venomous cribellate orb weaver spiders.



COBWEB

Also known as a "tangled web", this type is made by house spiders.



FUNNEL-WEB

This tubular style is built by funnel-web spiders.

BUILDING A WEB

Orb spiders produce a strong silk "thread" from their abdomen, which they use for spinning webs. The finished web is sticky, so that it can trap insects that pass by for the spider to eat.



1 FRAMEWORK

The spider lets out a thread, which catches on a twig. It then attaches the other end to another twig. Next, it attaches a looser thread to the same spot and then suspends itself from a third thread in the middle.



2 SPIRAL THREADS

Once the third thread is attached, the spider spins spiral threads to complete the web. These threads are not sticky.



3 STICKY THREADS

Finally, the spider replaces the spiral threads with sticky threads, ready to catch its prey. It then eats the non-sticky threads.

SPIDER SIZES

The world's smallest spider, the Patu Digua, has a body about the size of a pin head. The largest spider, the Goliath Birdeater Tarantula, has a leg span of 28 cm (11 in).



PATU DIGUA
SPIDER



GOLIATH BIRDEATER
TARANTULA

FEEDING

Spiders use fangs to kill their prey. Many also "spit" digestive fluids over the prey, to turn it to liquid, and then suck it up. All spiders eat insects, but some big spiders also eat lizards, frogs, and even fish.



DAANGEROUS SPIDERS

Only a small number of spiders are a danger to humans.

BRAZILIAN WANDERING SPIDER

The world's most poisonous spider wanders across jungle floors at night in search of food.

SYDNEY FUNNEL-WEB

When prey comes into contact with its web, this spider rushes out and delivers lots of bites, very quickly.

BROWN RECLUSE

Also known as "violin spiders", these bite with flesh-eating venom for which there is no cure.

BLACK WIDOW SPIDER

This spider's venom is very poisonous, but its bite is small.

THE OLDEST WEB
IS A 110-MILLION-
YEAR-OLD FOSSIL